

NE Modify

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Debug: Not finding right character.

Found the actual root cause — and you were right to be skeptical of everything else.

BPLM doesn't just use the references you filled in the editor. It **re-assigns** `Player Pawn / Player Cinematic` at runtime — the plugin shows `Get Player Pawn / Get Player Character` being used inside BPLM (in/around **BeginPlay**). So those variables are **populated by BPLM's own startup logic**, not guaranteed from the editor values.

So:

- **Start from 0:** the dialogue runs later in the level's life → BPLM has already populated `Player Pawn / Player Cinematic` → the swap reads them fine. ✓
- **Start from 133:** the dialogue fires so early that BPLM **hasn't populated them yet** → the swap reads **empty** → `Set Hidden` runs on nothing → "swap never happens." ✗

That's why both came back null, and why it's the same "ran too early" theme — except this time it's **BPLM's own variables that aren't ready**, not Narrative.

The fix — stop going through BPLM for the player

In the swap event, don't read BPLM → `Player Pawn`. Grab the player **directly**:

- **Player Character** → `Get Player Character` (or `Get Player Pawn`). Always valid, zero race, no BPLM.
- **Cine Character** → reference the placed actor directly, or use `Find Valid Actor Of Class With Tag` (tag `BP_StillNPC_Sal`). Also no BPLM.

This is exactly the "why can't I just reference the player directly?" you asked earlier — **nothing's stopping you, and it's the correct fix**. Once the swap gets its two actors without going through BPLM's not-yet-ready variables, it works from **any** start node.

Confirm (optional, 10 sec)

Print `Get Player Character` in the swap when starting from 133 — it'll be **valid** even though `BPLM` → `Player Pawn` was null. That proves the player is fine; only BPLM's copy was empty.

Swap those two reads to direct references and it'll fire correctly whether you start at 0 or 133.

(works for child BP as well)